neither stable nor clearly drawn, that new semiotic materials are actively used, and that in this they are significant.

Finally, considering interrelationships between anti-Muslim narratives in Myanmar and those circulating elsewhere offers an opportunity to situate a critique of these narratives closer to home. Nancy Scheper-Hughes (2002) has asked whether it is ever possible to "make sense" of mass violence. Such an attempt is a quest, she says, that is as old as Job and "as fraught with moral ambiguity for the anthropologist-as-witness as it was for the companions of Job who demanded an explanation compatible with their own views of a just God" (Scheper-Hughes 2002, p. 375). To ask such a question *about* Myanmar, I want to argue, is a quest that requires willingness to question, also, societies and politics *outside* Myanmar. That is, to refuse the parallels and relationships I have raised in this chapter — to cordon off narratives and violence in Myanmar, to treat them as beyond the pale, isolated, more like those of Holocaust deniers than anything else — misses a chance to shine a critical light on global dynamics that continue to be salient fifteen years after 9/11 (Kapferer 1988, p. xii).

Indeed, while some feel the claims of those who would deny the Holocaust should not be given even the legitimacy of a rebuttal, this is not universally the case. In Germany and other countries where there were Nazi collaborators, the years since the Holocaust have given rise to what Michael Geyer (1996, p. 169) has called a "politics of memory" with real stakes: it is not simply a question of whether the Holocaust is "denied"or remembered, but how it is remembered and understood, including the culpability and participation of ordinary people and how the ideologies that undergirded Nazi violence persist today. Attempting to make sense of violence in Myanmar is, meanwhile, an imperative to consider the operation and mobilization of such violence at home. At an event held in Washington DC during September 2015, for example, Myanmar's then foreign minister, Wunna Maung Lwin, compared his government's handling of "illegal immigrants" in Rakhine State to America's own immigration policies. An AP reporter who attended the event described these remarks as triggering "awkward laughter" (Pennington 2015). Such a response is another shameful refusal of what should be no laughing matter — along the Myanmar–Bangladesh border, along the US–Mexico border, and in the parallels and relations between the two. Violence in Myanmar is both related to and illustrative of the violence embedded within narratives that help to justify militarized border regions, indefinite detention and torture,